

In the Name of God

Asian Cultural Dialogues Conference

January 13-15, 2018

Islamic Republic of Iran

Thanks to its extensive capacities, culture has always proven to be the most appropriate media and most effective strategy for interaction and dialogue among the nations and for exploring proper grounds and solutions for proximity of viewpoints and mutual understanding among the world nations. The emergence and development of sciences and civilizations are chiefly a result of cultural relations and interactions among the human communities. Cultural dialogues prepare the grounds for free and respectful exchange of views among individuals as well as reference groups and institutions, thus prove to be highly influential in the path toward peaceful coexistence and sustainable security among nations. Today, under various tensions and challenges that dominate the international relations, cultural dialogues can prove to be an inevitable necessity and an effective strategy – more than ever – in establishing relations with and creating sustainable cooperation among the elite for collaboration in exploring appropriate cultural solutions for changing the status quo.

The Islamic Republic of Iran, as a country with millennia-old civilization and cultural history and with valuable religious and cultural assets, has always embarked on cultural cooperation. Adhering to culture and cultural dialogues, the Islamic Republic of Iran has always tried to boost friendly ties with other nations. The establishment of the Permanent Secretariat of International Cultural Dialogues at the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization (ICRO) in cooperation and partnership with a number of domestic and foreign scientific and academic institutions, is an effort toward preparing appropriate grounds for sustainable exchange of views among the elite and Iranian and non-Iranian reference groups. This is to realize access to mutual understanding, expansion of convergence and cooperation toward development, as well as promoting cultural and friendly ties and cooperation in the highly complicated and challenging international and regional scenes.

Due to the diverse and extensive cultural capacities in this region, organizing the cultural dialogues among Asian elites and thinkers is an essential priority of the Secretariat of Cultural Dialogues. Pursuant to the previous regional conference of the Cultural Dialogues in Asia, held last year in India, Malaysia, Kazakhstan, China and Turkey the Secretariat is honored to hold the first International Conference of Asian Cultural Dialogues, focusing on the following theme: **“Asia’s Cultural Diversity and Plurality: Opportunities for Convergence and Cooperation”**. The dialogues will be held on January 13-15, 2018 simultaneously in Tehran, Mashhad, Babolsar and Hamedan. This year’s conference intends to prepare the grounds for constructive interaction and exchange of views among the Asian elites. Over 70 highly distinguished elites, thinkers as well as

cultural and academic figures and scholars from 20 Asian countries will participate in the specialized panels hosted by the Tehran University, Ferdowsi University of Mashhad, Bu-Ali Sina University of Hamedan, Mazandaran University, Asian Interparliamentary Assembly, and Asia Cooperation Dialogue. The participants will exchange views on the 4 following topics in specialized commissions:

1. Iran and the Subcontinent Cultural Dialogue

- Topic: Mysticism and Sufism: Capacities and Opportunities
- Time: January 14-15, 2018
- Venue: Mashhad, Ferdowsi University of Mashhad

2. Iran, East & Southeast Asia Cultural Dialogue

- Topic: Cultural and Historical Bonds
- Time: January 14-15, 2018
- Venue: Tehran, Faculty of World Studies, Tehran University

3. Iran, Central Asia, Turkey and the Caucasus Cultural Dialogue

- Topic: Common Cultural and Historical Heritage
- Time: January 14-15, 2018
- Venue: Babolsar, Mazandaran University

4. D8 Member University Presidents Cultural Dialogue

- Topic: Cultural Diversity in Asia: Opportunities and Capacities for Interaction, Cooperation and Convergence
- Time: January 14-15, 2018
- Venue: Hamedan, Bu-Ali University of Hamedan

Conference Schedule

		Program	
Day	Date	Morning	Afternoon
Friday	Jan. 12	Arrival of the guests at Tehran & Esteghlal Hotel	Staying at the hotel
Saturday	Jan. 13	Opening ceremony at the ICRO Conference Hall 9:00 – 12:00	Accompanying the guests to the venue of the specialized commissions which will be held in Tehran, Mashhad, Babolsar and Hamedan
Sunday	Jan. 14	Opening the specialized commission in Tehran and in other host cities	Continuation of the discussions at the specialized commissions
Monday	Jan. 15	Closing ceremony	Departure of the guests

Notes:

1. Except for the commission of East & Southeast Asia, please check out the hotel on Saturday morning before leaving for the opening ceremony.
2. Following the opening ceremony, each honorable guest will participate at the specialized commission.
3. The language of the commissions will be in English and Persian (Farsi). In the commission of Central Asia, Turkey and the Caucasus, Persian-Russian and Russian-Persian translation service will also be available.
4. Exchange of views takes priority over abstract presentation. Therefore it is highly requested that the honorable guests make the optimal use of their time to express their views, suggestions and their executive strategies for developing cultural relations.
5. All programs will be advanced according to the preplanned schedule by the Secretariat of International Cultural Dialogues and the universities hosting the conference and specialized commissions. Therefore, it is kindly requested that any other business outside the schedule shall be avoided. (In case of emergency please contact your guides)
6. Please make sure you have taken enough warm clothes for winter time in Iran.

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